

Daily AI, Crypto & Tech Power Briefing

June 30, 2026

Stablecoin Alliances Expand as AI Investors Get More Selective

Today is about infrastructure power: payment networks, stablecoin rails, chip supply chains and the rules that decide who can scale safely.

The strongest crypto story is Open USD, a new stablecoin backed by BlackRock, Google and Coinbase. In AI, investors are still excited, but they are asking harder questions about competition, capital spending and governance.

1. Open USD shows stablecoins are becoming an alliance business

Wall Street Journal · June 30, 2026

BlackRock, Google Join Banks and Crypto Firms in Backing New Stablecoin

The story

A new dollar-backed stablecoin called Open USD is being launched by a consortium that includes BlackRock, Google and Coinbase. It is expected to launch later this year on Base, Solana and other networks.

The important detail is the partner list. More than 140 companies have shown interest, including Visa, Stripe and Mastercard. The fight is becoming less about one issuer and more about distribution, payment partners and default settlement rails.

Why it matters

This is a direct challenge to Circle's USDC business. Circle shares fell sharply after the announcement because investors

now see a serious new competitor with strong network effects before the token is even live.

Policy matters here because stablecoins are now treated more like payment infrastructure. The Genius Act gave dollar stablecoins more legal legitimacy, but it also makes competition more sensitive: regulators will watch reserves, redemption, consumer protection and whether large platforms gain too much control over digital money rails.

What to watch

- Whether Open USD actually launches on schedule and whether partners use it in real payment flows.
 - Whether Circle responds with lower fees, new partnerships or deeper bank integrations.
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2. The UK is trying to make crypto rules strict enough, but not too strict

Financial Times · June 30, 2026

[UK regulator waters down landmark crypto rules](#)

The story

The UK's Financial Conduct Authority has softened parts of its upcoming crypto framework after industry pushback. The rules will apply from October 2027, and companies can start applying from September 30, 2026.

The FCA lowered capital requirements for some non-systemic stablecoin issuers and reduced the capital coverage required for crypto trading assets. Smaller or lower-risk firms will also avoid some public disclosure requirements.

Why it matters

This is a classic regulatory balancing act. The UK wants stronger consumer protection and market confidence, but it does not want crypto firms to move to the U.S., Europe or other friendlier markets.

The bigger message is that crypto is becoming normal financial regulation. Firms will need capital, stress tests, custody controls and risk management. DeFi will likely be the next hard question,

especially when there is an identifiable controlling entity.

What to watch

- Whether major exchanges and stablecoin issuers apply for UK licenses under the new regime.
 - How the FCA handles DeFi rules without killing open protocols or ignoring real consumer risk.
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3. Nvidia is still powerful, but the AI chip trade is getting more crowded

Barron's · June 30, 2026

How Nvidia Became a Chip Stock Loser-and Why It Might Stay That Way

The story

Barron's says Nvidia has underperformed the broader chip sector in the first half of 2026. Nvidia is still up for the year, but it has lagged far behind the PHLX Semiconductor Index.

The reason is not that AI demand disappeared. The reason is that AI spending is spreading across more suppliers: AMD, custom chip designers, memory companies and CPU specialists. Nvidia is looking to its next-generation Vera Rubin hardware to rebuild a clearer lead.

Why it matters

This is an important shift for investors. In the early AI boom, Nvidia looked like the cleanest way to own the theme. Now hyperscalers want bargaining power, supply security and less dependence on one vendor.

For Nvidia, the business is still strong, but expectations are much higher. If Big Tech faces pressure to justify AI capital expenditure, chip suppliers may not all win equally.

What to watch

- Whether Vera Rubin creates a big enough performance gap to protect Nvidia's pricing power.
 - Whether Microsoft, Google, Amazon and Meta slow AI capex growth or push harder into custom chips.
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4. DeepMind's ethics work shows AI alignment is not just a technical problem

The Guardian · June 30, 2026

'There's this deep mystery of what, actually, is this thing?': the philosopher inside Google DeepMind AI

The story

The Guardian profiles Iason Gabriel, a political philosopher working inside Google DeepMind. His work focuses on alignment, values and the question of how AI systems should behave when different users and societies want different things.

The article is not a product launch, but it matters because frontier AI is moving from chatbots into agents that can take actions. Once AI systems can act for users, the question becomes not only what they can do, but what they should be allowed to do.

Why it matters

This is where AI policy becomes more serious. Alignment is not only a coding problem. It is also about accountability, values, military use, user dependence, bias, misinformation and who gets to decide the rules for powerful systems.

For companies, ethics work is becoming part of product risk management. If AI agents make decisions, book services, move information or operate inside companies, bad behavior can create legal, reputational and national security problems.

What to watch

- Whether AI labs turn ethics frameworks into real product controls and audit systems.
- Whether governments require clearer rules for autonomous agents before they are widely deployed in business.

5. Bitcoin is still below \$60,000 because the market wants proof of demand

The Economic Times · June 30, 2026

Bitcoin remains stuck below \$60,000 as traders eye Fed outlook and institutional demand

The story

Bitcoin stayed below \$60,000 on Tuesday, trading around \$59,437. Traders are watching the Federal Reserve outlook and signs of institutional demand.

This is not a collapse story, but it is a confidence story. Bitcoin has not yet found a strong enough catalyst to pull buyers back after ETF outflows and a weaker first half.

Why it matters

Bitcoin is still behaving like a macro risk asset. If rates stay high or institutional flows are weak, the price has trouble breaking above important levels.

The gap between stablecoins and bitcoin is becoming more visible. Stablecoin infrastructure is getting more corporate and regulated, while bitcoin still depends heavily on investor flows, liquidity and market sentiment.

What to watch

- Whether bitcoin can reclaim \$60,000 and hold it for several sessions.
 - Whether ETF flows and institutional demand improve as July begins.
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Useful terms

stablecoin rails - 稳定币支付轨道	consortium - 联盟 / 财团
distribution - 分发能力 / 渠道能力	settlement rails - 结算轨道
network effects - 网络效应	redemption - 赎回 / 兑付
consumer protection - 消费者保护	regulatory framework - 监管框架
capital requirement - 资本要求	stress test - 压力测试
custody controls - 托管控制	identifiable controlling entity - 可识别的控制实体
AI capex - AI 资本开支	custom chip - 定制芯片
hyperscaler - 超大规模云服务商	pricing power - 定价权
supplier concentration - 供应商集中度	AI alignment - AI 对齐
autonomous agent - 自主智能体	product risk management - 产品风险管理
audit system - 审计系统	institutional demand - 机构需求
macro risk asset - 宏观风险资产	market catalyst - 市场催化剂

Today's big picture

Today's big picture is that both AI and crypto are moving into the infrastructure stage. The winners will not only have good technology; they will control distribution, trust, compliance and scarce supply.

The contrast is sharp: stablecoins are gaining real corporate partners and clearer regulation, while bitcoin still needs fresh demand. In AI, Nvidia remains important, but the next phase looks more competitive and more policy-sensitive.